

# US Patent & Trademark Office

## Patent Public Search | Text View

---

|                      |                    |
|----------------------|--------------------|
| United States Patent | 12402743           |
| Kind Code            | B2                 |
| Date of Patent       | September 02, 2025 |
| Inventor(s)          | Threlfall; John    |

---

### Coffee filter holder

---

#### Abstract

A coffee filter holder for a coffee filter element used with a coffee cup that has a base, a surrounding sidewall extending from the base, and the coffee cup surrounding sidewall terminating in a coffee cup rim defining a coffee cup interior, the coffee filter holder comprising a first surrounding sidewall, thus forming a cone shape about a first longitudinal axis for the first surrounding sidewall, a second surrounding sidewall about a second longwise axis that has an aperture disposed therethrough the second surrounding sidewall in two places along the first longitudinal axis such that the cone narrow end is disposed therethrough the aperture, with the second surrounding sidewall placed on a coffee cup rim with the wide end of the cone facing upward. Wherein the wide end of the cone received the coffee filter and ground coffee to pour hot water into that drips to the cup interior.

---

|                   |                                      |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Inventors:</b> | <b>Threlfall; John (Volcano, HI)</b> |
| <b>Applicant:</b> | <b>Threlfall; John (Volcano, HI)</b> |
| <b>Family ID:</b> | <b>84104105</b>                      |
| <b>Appl. No.:</b> | <b>17/750371</b>                     |
| <b>Filed:</b>     | <b>May 22, 2022</b>                  |

#### Prior Publication Data

|                            |                         |
|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Document Identifier</b> | <b>Publication Date</b> |
| US 20220369846 A1          | Nov. 24, 2022           |

#### Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63192103 20210524

---

#### Publication Classification

**Int. Cl.:** A47J31/02 (20060101); A47J31/06 (20060101)

**U.S. Cl.:**

**CPC** A47J31/02 (20130101); A47J31/06 (20130101);

## Field of Classification Search

**CPC:** A47J (31/02); A47J (31/06); A47J (31/005); A47J (31/0615); A47J (31/0626); A47J (45/02)

**USPC:** 99/279; 99/285; 99/286; 99/295; 99/304; 99/306; 99/315; 99/316; 99/317; 99/323; 99/495; 426/77; 426/78; 426/84; 426/115; 426/132; 426/420; 426/433; 426/435; 426/594

---

## References Cited

### U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

| Patent No.   | Issued Date | Patentee Name | U.S. Cl.  | CPC        |
|--------------|-------------|---------------|-----------|------------|
| 2004/0222147 | 12/2003     | Post          | 210/493.1 | A47J 31/02 |
| 2020/0288900 | 12/2019     | Molnar        | N/A       | A47J 31/02 |

---

*Primary Examiner:* Nguyen; Phuong T

---

## Background/Summary

RELATED PATENT APPLICATION (1) This patent application claims the benefit of U.S. provisional patent application Ser. No. 63/192,103 filed on May 24, 2021 by John Threlfall of Volcano, Hi., U.S.

### FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention generally relates to coffee accessories. More particularly, the present invention is used with a coffee holder preferably for one-cup service, i.e. to make a single cup at a time wherein the coffee filter holder supports a coffee filter over a single coffee cup to make a single cup of coffee.

### DESCRIPTION OF THE RELATED ART

(2) Cone shaped coffee filters are well known in the prior art typically being used with multiple cup coffee makers with ground coffee beans, it is a relatively new trend to make single cups of coffee with a typical cone shaped filter again using ground coffee beans, however, this left a need for single coffee cup cone filter holder or support, of which there are some products available in various configurations some of which are described in the prior art below, however, there not being many portable and collapsible single cup coffee filter holders.

(3) Looking at the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 4,519,911 to Shimizu, disclosed is a paper extractor including a support member in the form of a collar of a small wall-thickness having at its lower end two support legs facing each other, a filter attached to an inner surface of the support member, and coffee packs each including coffee powder sealed in a bag made of filter cloth or filter paper. The support legs in Shimizu of the support member are each formed with folds in the form of a letter V to allow the support legs to be deformed and project outwardly when they are bent at the folds, further by replacing the coffee pack by a new one, the paper extractor can be used several times before it is discarded, and the deformable support legs enable the paper extractor to be stably

supported on the upper edge of a coffee cup.

(4) Continuing in the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 4,560,475 to Kataoka, disclosed is a filter assembly for providing a filtrate such as coffee has a sack of filter paper adhered to the back of a fold able support plate, the support plate is constituted by an intermediate portion with an opening for pouring hot water therethrough, which is covered by the filter sack, and a pair of support legs connected with the opposite sides of the intermediate portion to have the latter therebetween. Each support leg in Kataoka is formed with at least one slot which extends symmetrically with respect to the longitudinal centerline of the support plate to define a plurality of coactive locking members, which are firmly engageable with a receptacle to support the filter assembly upright in a stable manner when the support legs are folded relative to the intermediate portion along preselected fold lines, the locking members may be defined by a pair of slots or a single generally U-shaped slot at each support leg, for example.

(5) Moving onward in the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 5,290,444 to Campbell, disclosed is a device for securing a coffee filter paper in a grounds container comprising a single thin sheet of thermo-plastic, heat resistant, resilient material having a plurality of fingers spaced symmetrically around the periphery, for placing adjacent a paper filter with its open central core at the center of the filter and in combination wedged into a coffee grounds container with the instant invention exposed.

(6) Continuing in the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 5,852,966 to Hursh, disclosed is a coffee filter comprising a cylindrical coffee retaining ring, and a cylindrical sleeve, the cylindrical sleeve being sized, and fitted so that it may be slidably mounted upon the cylindrical coffee retaining ring so that the inner surface of the cylindrical sleeve is in close proximity with the outer surface of the cylindrical coffee retaining ring, and comprising a sleeve and filter retaining means, that is fixedly attached to the cylindrical coffee retaining ring and to the cylindrical sleeve. The means in Hursh being capable upon such slidable mounting of the cylindrical sleeve of fixedly attaching the cylindrical sleeve to the cylindrical coffee retaining ring, and being capable of retaining a sheet of filter paper so that such paper underlies and spans across the lower end of the cylindrical coffee retaining ring.

(7) Further, in the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 6,425,317 to Simmons, disclosed is a filter basket having a wall configured to form a basket, the wall has a drain hole formed in a lower portion thereof and a regulating member for regulating a flow of liquid flowing through the basket into the drain hole. One embodiment in Simmons includes a pair of planar surfaces positioned within the basket and connected to an inner surface of the wall; the pair of planar surfaces define a longitudinal slot therebetween. The size of the slot in Simmons is configured to restrict the flow of fluid through the basket to maintain a predetermined level of fluid within the basket for a predetermined dwell period of about five minutes to about seven minutes. In Simmons, a method of brewing a beverage is also disclosed including the steps of placing a plurality of beverage flavor elements within a filter basket, dispensing water over the plurality of beverage flavor elements within the filter basket at a predetermined flow rate, providing structure within the filter basket to restrict the flow of water through the filter basket such that a level of water in the basket rises to a predetermined level at which the flow rate of water into the filter basket equals a flow rate of water out of the basket, and continuing dispensing water over the plurality of beverage flavor elements for a predetermined dwell period after the flow rate of water into the filter basket equals the flow rate of water out of the basket.

(8) Next, in the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 7,150,219 to DeLonghi, disclosed is a coffee machine that has a filter holder receiving a filter cup adapted to hold a suspension of hot water and grounds on a generally horizontal filter forming a floor of the cup. The hot water infused by DeLonghi has the grounds passed down through the filter as coffee, a side wall formed with a screw-thread is provided on the cup underneath and generally perpendicular to the filter. A dispenser on the cup on DeLonghi is underneath the filter has an outlet directed generally perpendicularly at the side wall for spraying the coffee substantially perpendicularly against the screw-thread and thereby

generating froth.

(9) Moving onward, in the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 8,906,440 to Otto, disclosed is a coffee filter basket includes a filter retainer having an outer shell with an upper end having open top and a bottom including an opening, an insert having an upper collar of a less than the diameter than the upper end of the retainer to fit therein and having a lower extension which when a filter is disposed within the retainer. The insert in Otto is disposed within the filter insert press-fits within the retainer to retain the filter adjacent the retainer shell, and a removable top having an outer perimeter lip portion of at least that of the diameter of the upper end of the retainer and a lower collar portion of a diameter less than the diameter of the upper collar and configured to press-fit therein to secure the insert in the retainer, wherein the removable top has an opening, wherein a method of use is provided.

(10) Continuing, in the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 10,051,987 to Bebo, disclosed is a tea and coffee brewing apparatus includes a container for receiving a brewed beverage and a filter receptacle for receiving contents to be brewed. Guides in Bebo are disposed on the filter receptacle for lowering the filter receptacle wholly inside the container for storage mode and also raising the filter receptacle above the container for brew mode. Supports in Bebo are disposed on the guides hold the filter receptacle up and above the container so that a beverage may be drip brewed into the container.

(11) Continuing, in the prior art in U.S. Pat. No. 10,144,580 to Schwarz, disclosed is a brew basket is provided for use in a beverage brewing machine, the brew basket includes a body defining a brewing reservoir that extends along a longitudinal length from an open top to a bottom end having one or more openings. The brewing reservoir in Schwarz has an internally tapered multi-sided three-dimensional (3D) shape, the brewing reservoir having a first cross-sectional area at the open top that progressively narrows along the longitudinal length of the multi-sided 3D shape to a smaller second cross-sectional area proximate to the one or more openings at the bottom end. The open top in Schwarz is configured to receive heated water from the brewing machine during a brewing operation with brewed beverage discharging from the one or more openings. The multi-sided 3D shape of the brewing reservoir configured to receive a filter pack having a generally tapered multi-sided 3D shape similar to the multi-sided 3D shape of the brewing reservoir.

(12) Next, in the prior art in U.S. Design Pat. No. D250,804 to Nilsson, disclosed is a coffee filter holder that has the traditional conic shape.

(13) Further, in the prior art in U.S. Design Pat. No. D406,725 to Joergensen, disclosed is a single cup coffee filter holder that has a cylindrical shape that inserts into a single coffee cup.

(14) What is needed is a coffee filter holder that is portable, being collapsible and potentially pocketable to be easily carried by an individual to be used at either their favorite coffee shop, on the road hiking/camping, or simply at home. The coffee filter holder would preferably not be disposable and would be reusable, with the ability to hold its desired shape for re-use.

#### SUMMARY OF INVENTION

(15) Broadly, the present invention is a coffee filter holder for supporting a coffee filter element for use with a single serving coffee cup that has a base, a coffee cup surrounding sidewall extending from the base, and the coffee cup surrounding sidewall terminating in a coffee cup rim all defining a coffee cup interior, the coffee filter holder comprising a first surrounding sidewall including a first outer surface and an opposing first inner surface, further the first surrounding sidewall having a first proximal end portion and an opposing first distal end portion with a first longitudinal axis spanning therebetween. Wherein the first proximal end portion has a first proximal peripheral margin that defines a first proximal termination of the first surrounding sidewall, wherein the first proximal peripheral margin has a first proximal peripheral distance, further the first distal end portion has a first distal peripheral margin that defines a first distal termination of the first surrounding sidewall. Wherein the first distal peripheral margin has a first distal peripheral distance, further the first distal peripheral distance is greater than the first proximal peripheral

distance thus forming a cone shape for the first surrounding sidewall, wherein the first inner surface, the first proximal peripheral margin, and the first distal peripheral margin all define a first surrounding sidewall interior.

(16) Further, the coffee holder includes a second surrounding sidewall including a second outer surface and an opposing second inner surface, further the second surrounding sidewall having a second primary end portion and an opposing second secondary end portion with a second longwise axis spanning therebetween. Wherein the first longitudinal axis and the second longwise axis are positioned perpendicular to one another as the second surrounding sidewall has an aperture disposed therethrough the second surrounding sidewall in two places along the first longitudinal axis such that the first proximal end portion is partially received in the aperture. Wherein operationally a portion of the second surrounding sidewall second outer surface rests against the coffee cup rim thus suspending the first surrounding sidewall over the coffee cup interior with the first proximal peripheral margin adjacent to the coffee cup interior, wherein the coffee filter element is placed within the first surrounding sidewall interior with ground coffee placed within the coffee filter element and hot water poured over the ground coffee to create a single cup of coffee.

(17) These and other objects of the present invention will become more readily appreciated and understood from a consideration of the following detailed description of the exemplary embodiments of the present invention when taken together with the accompanying drawings, in which;

---

## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 shows an upper perspective view of the planar element that includes the parallel first and second slots forming a single side of the coffee filter holder;

(2) FIG. 2 shows an upper perspective view of four planar elements interconnected with one another to form a cone shape for a fifth surrounding sidewall that includes the fifth proximal end portion that terminates into the support foot shown;

(3) FIG. 3 shows an upper perspective use view of the four planar elements interconnected with one another to form a cone shape for a fifth surrounding sidewall that includes the fifth proximal end portion that terminates into the support foot shown that are disposed upon the coffee cup rim with the coffee filter, ground coffee, and hot water shown dripping into the interior of the coffee cup after passing through the ground coffee and coffee filter;

(4) FIG. 4 shows a top view of the coffee filter holder with the third surrounding sidewall interior without the planar member shown for clarity, with the third proximal peripheral distance shown at the bottom of the third surrounding sidewall;

(5) FIG. 5 shows a perspective view of the coffee filter holder with the third surrounding sidewall interior with the planar member shown separate for clarity, with the third proximal termination/margin shown at the bottom of the third surrounding sidewall;

(6) FIG. 6 shows a perspective use view of the coffee filter holder with the third surrounding sidewall with coffee and filter disposed in the interior with the planar member shown engaging the third proximal end portion of the third surrounding sidewall as the planar member rests on top of the coffee cup with the interior of the coffee cup also shown;

(7) FIG. 7 shows a top view of the fourth surrounding sidewall collapsed or folded flat for portability with the bending along the fold lines;

(8) FIG. 8 shows a side elevation use view of the fourth surrounding sidewall opened and disposed upon the coffee cup;

(9) FIG. 9 shows a top use view of the fourth surrounding sidewall opened and disposed upon the coffee cup, wherein shown is the coffee filter element, the ground coffee, with the fourth proximal

peripheral margin that communication with the coffee cup interior;

(10) FIG. 10 shows a flat plan top fold flat view of the fourth surrounding sidewall showing the fourth outer surface and the fourth inner surface;

(11) FIG. 11 shows a top view of the first and second surrounding sidewalls of the coffee filter holder, also showing the first proximal peripheral margin and termination of the first surrounding sidewall;

(12) FIG. 12 shows a flat plan view of the first and second surrounding sidewalls of the coffee filter holder that are shown assembled together for portability;

(13) FIG. 13 shows a perspective view of FIG. 12, with FIG. 13 showing the first and second surrounding sidewalls of the coffee filter holder that are shown assembled together for portability with the aperture of the second surrounding sidewall;

(14) FIG. 14 shows a top view of the second surrounding sidewall alone showing in particular the aperture of the second surrounding sidewall therethrough in two places representing the folded over nature of the second surrounding sidewall as shown in FIG. 15;

(15) FIG. 15 shows a side elevation use view of the first and second surrounding sidewalls assembled to one another of the coffee filter holder, with the first surrounding sidewall inserted into the second surrounding sidewall with the first proximal end portion being received into the aperture of the second surrounding sidewall;

(16) FIG. 16 shows a side elevation use view of the first and second surrounding sidewalls assembled to one another of the coffee filter holder, with the first surrounding sidewall inserted into the second surrounding sidewall with the first proximal end portion being received into the aperture of the second surrounding sidewall with a cutaway of the coffee cup showing the dripping of the hot water;

(17) FIG. 17 shows a rotated side elevation use view from FIG. 15, with FIG. 17 showing of the first and second surrounding sidewalls assembled to one another of the coffee filter holder, with the first surrounding sidewall inserted into the second surrounding sidewall with the first proximal end portion being received into the aperture of the second surrounding sidewall; and

(18) FIG. 18 shows a coffee filter holder with the third surrounding sidewall with the planar member that is inserted into the third surrounding sidewall for portability, see FIGS. 5 and 6 for the planar member removed from the third surrounding sidewall to be placed on the coffee cup for support of the third surrounding sidewall for the coffee filter holder in use.

#### REFERENCE NUMBERS IN DRAWINGS

(19) **50** Coffee filter holder **55** Coffee filter element **60** Ground coffee **65** Hot water **70** A single serving coffee cup **75** Base of the coffee cup **70 80** Surrounding sidewall of the coffee cup **70 85** Coffee cup rim of the surrounding sidewall **80 90** Interior of the coffee cup **70 95** First surrounding sidewall **100** First outer surface of the first surrounding sidewall **95 105** First inner surface of the first surrounding sidewall **95 110** First proximal end portion of the first surrounding sidewall **95 115** First distal end portion of the first surrounding sidewall **95 120** First longitudinal axis of the first surrounding sidewall **95 125** First proximal peripheral margin of the first surrounding sidewall **95 130** First proximal termination of the first surrounding sidewall **95 135** First proximal peripheral distance of the first surrounding sidewall **95 140** First distal peripheral margin of the first surrounding sidewall **95 145** First distal termination of the first surrounding sidewall **95 150** First distal peripheral distance of the first surrounding sidewall **95 155** First distal peripheral distance is greater than the first proximal peripheral distance **135 160** Cone shape for the first surrounding sidewall **95 165** First surrounding sidewall interior **170** Second surrounding sidewall **175** Second outer surface of the second surrounding sidewall **170 180** Second inner surface of the second surrounding sidewall **170 185** Second primary end portion of the second surrounding sidewall **170 190** Second secondary end portion of the second surrounding sidewall **170 195** Second longwise axis of the second surrounding sidewall **170 200** Perpendicular position of the first longitudinal axis **120** and the second longwise axis **195 205** Aperture of the second surrounding sidewall **170**

disposed therethrough in two places along the first longitudinal axis **120 210** The first proximal end portion is partially received in the aperture **205 215** Portion of the second surrounding sidewall **170** second outer surface **175** rests against the coffee cup rim **85** thus suspending the first surrounding sidewall **95** over the coffee cup interior **90** with the first proximal peripheral margin **125** adjacent to the coffee cup interior **90 220** Placing the coffee filter element **55** within the first surrounding sidewall interior **165** with the ground coffee **60** placed within the coffee filter element **55** and the hot water **65** poured over the ground coffee **60** to create a single cup of coffee **225** Third surrounding sidewall **230** Third outer surface of the third surrounding sidewall **225 235** Third inner surface of the third surrounding sidewall **225 240** Third proximal end portion of the third surrounding sidewall **225 245** Third distal end portion of the third surrounding sidewall **225 250** Third longitudinal axis of the third surrounding sidewall **225 255** Third proximal peripheral margin of the third surrounding sidewall **225 260** Third proximal termination of the third surrounding sidewall **225 265** Third proximal peripheral distance of the third surrounding sidewall **225 270** Third distal peripheral margin of the third surrounding sidewall **225 275** Third distal termination of the third surrounding sidewall **225 280** Third distal peripheral distance of the third surrounding sidewall **225 285** Third distal peripheral distance **280** is greater than the third proximal peripheral distance **265 290** Cone shape for the third surrounding sidewall **225 295** Third surrounding sidewall **225** interior **300** Planar member **305** Planar plane of the planar member **300 310** Outer perimeter of the planar member **300 315** Planar aperture of the planar member **300** disposed therethrough the planar member **300 320** Perpendicular position of the third longitudinal axis **250** and the planar plane **305 325** Partial receiving of the third proximal end portion **240** in the planar aperture **315 330** Portion of the planar member **300** rests against the coffee cup rim **85** thus suspending the third surrounding sidewall **225** over the coffee cup interior **90** with the third proximal peripheral margin **255** adjacent to the coffee cup interior **90**, wherein the coffee filter element **55** is placed within the third surrounding sidewall interior **295** with ground coffee **60** placed within the coffee filter element **55** and hot water **65** poured over the ground coffee **60** to create a single cup of coffee **335** Flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **340** Fourth outer surface of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 345** Fourth inner surface of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 350** Fourth proximal end portion of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 355** Fourth distal end portion of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 360** Fourth longitudinal axis of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 365** Fourth proximal peripheral margin of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 370** Fourth proximal termination of the fourth surrounding sidewall **335 375** Fourth proximal peripheral distance of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 380** Fourth distal peripheral margin of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 385** Fourth distal termination of the fourth surrounding sidewall **335 390** Fourth distal peripheral distance of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 395** Fourth distal peripheral distance **390** is greater than the fourth proximal peripheral distance **375 400** Forming a cone shape for the fourth surrounding sidewall **335 405** Fourth surrounding sidewall interior **410** Fourth surrounding sidewall forms a hexagonal pyramid in shape **415** Six fold lines in the fourth surrounding sidewall **335 420** Each fold line running substantially parallel to the fourth longitudinal axis **360 425** Fold flat of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335 430** At least one of the fold lines **415** has a projection of excess of the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** outside of the hexagonal pyramid shape **410** to facilitate the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** to fold flat for transportation and storage **435** Rest of a portion of the fourth proximal end portion **350** against the coffee cup rim **85** thus suspending the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** over the coffee cup interior **90** with the fourth proximal peripheral margin **365** adjacent to the coffee cup interior **90**, wherein the coffee filter element **55** is placed within the fourth surrounding sidewall interior **405** with ground coffee **60** placed within the coffee filter element **55** and hot water **65** poured over the ground coffee **60** to create a single cup of coffee **440** Planar element **445** Lengthwise axis of the planar element **440 450** Outer perimeter of the planar element **440 455** Polygon shape of the outer

perimeter **450 460** Partial first slot therethrough the planar element **440 465** First length of the partial first slot **460 470** Substantially parallel relationship of the first length **465** to the lengthwise axis **445 475** Partial second slot therethrough the planar element **440 480** Second length of the partial second slot **475 485** Acute angle of the partial second slot **475** to the lengthwise axis **445 490** Fifth surrounding sidewall **495** Engaging the first slot **460** and the second slot **475** to one another on separate planar elements **440** such that the fifth surrounding sidewall **490** is formed by at least three of the planar elements **440 500** Fifth outer surface of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 505** Fifth inner surface of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 510** Fifth proximal end portion of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 515** Fifth distal end portion of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 520** Fifth longitudinal axis of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 525** Fifth proximal peripheral margin of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 530** Fifth proximal termination of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 535** Fifth proximal peripheral distance of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 540** Fifth distal peripheral margin of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 545** Fifth distal termination of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 550** Fifth distal peripheral distance of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 555** Cone shape of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 560** Fifth distal peripheral distance **550** is greater than the fifth proximal peripheral distance **535** thus forming the cone shape **555** for the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 565** Interior of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490 570** A portion of the fifth proximal end portion **510** rests against the coffee cup rim **85** thus suspending the fifth surrounding sidewall **490** over the coffee cup interior **90** with the fifth proximal peripheral margin **525** adjacent to the coffee cup interior **90**, wherein the coffee filter element **55** is placed within the fifth surrounding sidewall interior **565** with ground coffee **60** placed within the coffee filter element **55** and hot water **65** poured over the ground coffee **60** to create a single cup of coffee **575** Interface aperture disposed in the third proximal end portion **240** of the third surrounding sidewall **225** to receive a portion of the planar aperture **315**

#### DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(20) With initial reference to FIG. 1 shown is FIG. 1 shows an upper perspective view of the planar element **440** that includes the parallel first **460** and second **475** slots forming a single side of the coffee filter holder **50**. Next, FIG. 2 shows an upper perspective view of four planar elements **440** interconnected with one another to form a cone shape for a fifth surrounding sidewall **490** that includes the fifth proximal end portion **510** that terminates **530** into the support foot shown.

(21) Continuing, FIG. 3 shows an upper perspective use view of the four planar elements **440** interconnected with one another to form a cone shape for a fifth surrounding sidewall **490** that includes the fifth proximal end portion **510** that terminates **530** into the support foot shown that are disposed upon the coffee cup **70** rim **85** with the coffee filter **55**, ground coffee **60**, and hot water **65** shown dripping into the interior **90** of the coffee cup **70** after passing through the ground coffee **60** and coffee filter **55**.

(22) Further, FIG. 4 shows a top view of the coffee filter holder **50** with the third surrounding sidewall **225** interior **295** without the planar member **300** shown for clarity, with the third proximal peripheral distance **265** shown at the bottom of the third surrounding sidewall **225**. Next, FIG. 5 shows a perspective view of the coffee filter holder **50** with the third surrounding sidewall **225** interior **295** with the planar member **300** shown separate for clarity, with the third proximal termination **260**/margin **255** shown at the bottom of the third surrounding sidewall **225**.

(23) Continuing, FIG. 6 shows a perspective use view of the coffee filter holder **50** with the third surrounding sidewall **225** with round coffee **60** and filter **55** disposed in the interior **295** with the planar member **300** shown engaging the third proximal end portion **240** of the third surrounding sidewall **225** as the planar member **300** rests on top **85** of the coffee cup **70** with the interior **90** of the coffee cup **70** also shown.

(24) Next, FIG. 7 shows a top view of the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** collapsed or folded flat for portability with the bending along the fold lines **415**. Continuing, FIG. 8 shows a side elevation use view of the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** opened and disposed upon the coffee cup **70** rim



85. Further, FIG. 9 shows a top use view of the fourth surrounding sidewall 335 opened and disposed upon the coffee cup 70, wherein shown is the coffee filter element 55, the ground coffee 60, with the fourth proximal peripheral margin 365 that is in communication with the coffee cup interior 90. Next, FIG. 10 shows a flat plan top fold flat view of the fourth surrounding sidewall 335 showing the fourth outer surface 340 and the fourth inner surface 345.

(25) Further, FIG. 11 shows a top view of the first 95 and second 170 surrounding sidewalls of the coffee filter holder 50, also showing the first proximal peripheral margin 125 and proximal termination 130 of the first surrounding sidewall 95. Next, FIG. 12 shows a flat plan view of the first 95 and second 170 surrounding sidewalls of the coffee filter holder 50 that are shown assembled together for portability. Continuing, FIG. 13 shows a perspective view of FIG. 12, with FIG. 13 showing the first 95 and second 170 surrounding sidewalls of the coffee filter holder 50 that are shown assembled together for portability with the aperture 205 of the second surrounding sidewall 170.

(26) Moving onward, FIG. 14 shows a top view of the second surrounding sidewall 170 alone showing in particular the aperture 205 of the second surrounding sidewall 170 therethrough in two places representing the folded over nature of the second surrounding sidewall 170 as shown in FIG. 15. Next, FIG. 15 shows a side elevation use view of the first 95 and second 170 surrounding sidewalls assembled to one another of the coffee filter holder 50, with the first surrounding sidewall 95 inserted into the second surrounding sidewall 170 with the first proximal end portion 110 being received into the aperture 205 of the second surrounding sidewall 170.

(27) Continuing, FIG. 16 shows a side elevation use view of the first 95 and second 170 surrounding sidewalls assembled to one another of the coffee filter holder 50, with the first surrounding sidewall 95 inserted into the second surrounding sidewall 170 with the first proximal end portion 110 being received into the aperture 205 of the second surrounding sidewall 170 with a cutaway of the coffee cup 70 showing the dripping of the hot water 65.

(28) Further, FIG. 17 shows a rotated side elevation use view from FIG. 15, with FIG. 17 showing of the first 95 and second 170 surrounding sidewalls assembled to one another of the coffee filter holder 50, with the first surrounding sidewall 95 inserted into the second surrounding sidewall 170 with the first proximal end portion 110 being received into the aperture 205 of the second surrounding sidewall 170. Next, FIG. 18 shows a coffee filter holder 50 with the third surrounding sidewall 225 with the planar member 300 that is inserted into the third surrounding sidewall 225 for portability, see FIGS. 5 and 6 for the planar member 300 removed from the third surrounding sidewall 225 to be placed on the coffee cup 70 for support of the third surrounding sidewall 225 for the coffee filter holder 50 in use.

(29) Broadly in looking at FIGS. 11 to 17, a coffee filter holder 50 for supporting a coffee filter element 55 for use with a single serving coffee cup 70 that has a base 75, a coffee cup surrounding sidewall 80 extending from the base 75, and the coffee cup surrounding sidewall 80 terminating in a coffee cup rim 85 all defining a coffee cup interior 90, the coffee filter holder 50 comprising a first surrounding sidewall 95 including a first outer surface 100 and an opposing first inner surface 105, further the first surrounding sidewall 95 having a first proximal end portion 110 and an opposing first distal end portion 115 with a first longitudinal axis 120 spanning therebetween. Wherein the first proximal end portion 110 has a first proximal peripheral margin 125 that defines a first proximal termination 130 of the first surrounding sidewall 95, wherein the first proximal peripheral margin 125 has a first proximal peripheral distance 135, further the first distal end portion 115 has a first distal peripheral margin 140 that defines a first distal termination 145 of the first surrounding sidewall 95. Wherein the first distal peripheral margin 140 has a first distal peripheral distance 150, further the first distal peripheral distance 150 is greater 155 than the first proximal peripheral distance 135 thus forming a cone shape 160 for the first surrounding sidewall 95, wherein the first inner surface 105, the first proximal peripheral margin 125, and the first distal peripheral margin 140 all define a first surrounding sidewall interior 165.

(30) Further, again looking at FIGS. 11 to 17, the coffee filter holder 50 includes a second surrounding sidewall 170 including a second outer surface 175 and an opposing second inner surface 180, further the second surrounding sidewall 170 having a second primary end portion 185 and an opposing second secondary end portion 190 with a second longwise axis 190 spanning therebetween. Wherein the first longitudinal axis 120 and the second longwise axis 195 are positioned perpendicular 200 to one another as the second surrounding sidewall 170 has an aperture 205 disposed therethrough the second surrounding sidewall 170 in two places along the first longitudinal axis 120 such that the first proximal end portion 110 is partially received 210 in the aperture 205. Wherein operationally a portion 215 of the second surrounding sidewall 170 second outer surface 175 rests 215 against the coffee cup rim 85 thus suspending the first surrounding sidewall 95 over the coffee cup interior 90 with the first proximal peripheral margin 125 adjacent to the coffee cup interior 90, wherein the coffee filter element 55 is placed 220 within the first surrounding sidewall interior 165 with ground coffee 60 placed within the coffee filter element 55 and hot water 65 poured over the ground coffee 60 to create a single cup of coffee.

(31) Referring to FIGS. 4 to 6 and FIG. 18, a coffee filter holder 50 includes a third surrounding sidewall 225 including a third outer surface 230 and an opposing third inner surface 235, further the third surrounding sidewall 225 having a third proximal end portion 240 and an opposing third distal end portion 245 with a third longitudinal axis 250 spanning therebetween, wherein the third proximal end portion 240 has a third proximal peripheral margin 255 that defines a third proximal termination 260 of the third surrounding sidewall 225, wherein the third proximal peripheral margin 255 has a third proximal peripheral distance 265, further the third distal end portion 245 has a third distal peripheral margin 270 that defines a third distal termination 275 of the third surrounding sidewall 225. Wherein the third distal peripheral margin 270 has a third distal peripheral distance 280, further the third distal peripheral distance 280 is greater than 285 the third proximal peripheral distance 265 thus forming a cone shape 290 for the third surrounding sidewall 225, wherein the third inner surface 235, the third proximal peripheral margin 255, and the third distal peripheral margin 270 all define a third surrounding sidewall interior 295.

(32) Referring again to FIGS. 4 to 6 and FIG. 18, the coffee filter holder 50 also includes a planar member 300 with a planar plane 305, the planar member 300 also having an outer perimeter 310 and a planar aperture 315 disposed therethrough the planar member 300, wherein the third longitudinal axis 250 and the planar plane 305 are positioned perpendicular 320 to one another, such that the third proximal end portion 240 is partially received 325 in the planar aperture 315. Wherein operationally a portion of the planar member 300 rests 330 against the coffee cup rim 85 thus suspending the third surrounding sidewall 225 over the coffee cup interior 90 with the third proximal peripheral margin 255 adjacent to the coffee cup interior 90, wherein the coffee filter element 55 is placed within the third surrounding sidewall interior 295 with ground coffee 60 placed within the coffee filter element 55 and hot water 65 poured over the ground coffee 60 to create a single cup of coffee.

(33) Optionally, in referring again to FIGS. 4 to 6 and FIG. 18, for the coffee filter holder 50, wherein the third proximal end portion 240 can further comprise an interface aperture 575, wherein the interface aperture 575 partially receives a portion of the planar aperture 315 to operationally removably engage the third surrounding sidewall 225 to the planar member 300.

(34) Another option, in referring again to FIGS. 4 to 6 and FIG. 18, for the coffee filter holder 50, wherein the third surrounding sidewall 225 can further comprise flexible corners that operationally allow a fold flat state of the third surrounding sidewall 225 that facilitates the planar member 300 to slip within the third surrounding interior 295 being adjacent to the third inner surface 235.

(35) Referring to FIGS. 7 to 10, a coffee filter holder 50 includes a flexible fourth surrounding sidewall 335 including a fourth outer surface 340 and an opposing fourth inner surface 345, further the fourth surrounding sidewall 335 having a fourth proximal end portion 350 and an opposing fourth distal end portion 355 with a fourth longitudinal axis 360 spanning therebetween, wherein

the fourth proximal end portion **350** has a fourth proximal peripheral margin **365** that defines a fourth proximal termination **370** of the fourth surrounding sidewall **335**. Wherein the fourth proximal peripheral margin **365** has a fourth proximal peripheral distance **375**, further the fourth distal end portion **355** has a fourth distal peripheral margin **380** that defines a fourth distal termination **385** of the fourth surrounding sidewall **335**, wherein the fourth distal peripheral margin **380** has a fourth distal peripheral distance **390**, further the fourth distal peripheral distance **390** is greater **395** than the fourth proximal peripheral distance **375** thus forming a cone shape **400** for the fourth surrounding sidewall **335**.

(36) Wherein the fourth inner surface **345**, the fourth proximal peripheral margin **365**, and the fourth distal peripheral margin **380** all define a fourth surrounding sidewall interior **405**, wherein the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** forms a hexagonal pyramid **410** in shape that has six fold lines **415** in the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** with each fold line **415** running substantially parallel **420** to the fourth longitudinal axis **360**, further at least one of the fold lines **415** has a projection of excess **430** fourth surrounding sidewall **335** outside of the hexagonal pyramid shape **410** to facilitate the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** to fold flat **425** for transportation and storage. Wherein operationally, a portion of the fourth proximal end portion **350** rests **435** against the coffee cup rim **85** thus suspending the fourth surrounding sidewall **335** over the coffee cup interior **90** with the fourth proximal peripheral margin **365** adjacent to the coffee cup interior **90**, wherein the coffee filter element **55** is placed within the fourth surrounding sidewall interior **405** with ground coffee **60** placed within the coffee filter element **55** and hot water **65** poured over the ground coffee **60** to create a single cup of coffee.

(37) Optionally, in referring to FIGS. **7** to **10**, for the coffee filter holder **50**, wherein the projection of excess **430** further comprises four projection of excess **430** sections having one on each corner of the flexible fourth surrounding sidewall **335** to operationally enable a symmetric fold flat state **425** and hexagonal pyramid shape **410** of the fourth surrounding sidewall **335**.

(38) Referring to FIGS. **1** to **3**, a coffee filter holder **50** includes at least three planar elements **440** that each include a lengthwise axis **445**, with each planar element **440** further including an outer perimeter **450** that forms a polygon shape **455**, wherein the outer perimeter **450** includes a partial first slot **460** therethrough the planar element **440** wherein a first length **465** of the partial first slot **460** is substantially parallel **470** to the lengthwise axis **445**, further the outer perimeter **450** includes an oppositely disposed partial second slot **475** with a second length **480** of the partial second slot **475** positioned at an acute angle **485** to the lengthwise axis **445**. Wherein the first slot **460** and said second slot **475** are engaged **495** to one another on separate planar elements such that a fifth surrounding sidewall **490** is formed by at least three of the planar elements **440**, the fifth surrounding sidewall including a fifth outer surface **500** and an opposing fifth inner surface **505**.

(39) Further the fifth surrounding sidewall **490** having a fifth proximal end portion **510** and an opposing fifth distal end portion **515** with a fifth longitudinal axis **520** spanning therebetween, wherein the fifth proximal end portion **510** has a fifth proximal peripheral margin **525** that defines a fifth proximal termination **530** of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490**. Wherein the fifth proximal peripheral margin **525** has a fifth proximal peripheral distance **535**, further the fifth distal end portion **515** has a fifth distal peripheral margin **540** that defines a fifth distal termination **545** of the fifth surrounding sidewall **490**, wherein the fifth distal peripheral margin **540** has a fifth distal peripheral distance **550**, further the fifth distal peripheral distance **550** is greater **560** than the fifth proximal peripheral distance **535** thus forming a cone shape **555** for the fifth surrounding sidewall **490**. Wherein the fifth inner surface **505**, the fifth proximal peripheral margin **525**, and the fifth distal peripheral margin **540** all define a fifth surrounding sidewall **490** interior **565**, wherein operationally a portion of the fifth proximal end portion **510** rests **570** against the coffee cup rim **85** thus suspending the fifth surrounding sidewall **490** over the coffee cup interior **90** with the fifth proximal peripheral margin **525** adjacent to the coffee cup interior **90**, wherein the coffee filter element **55** is placed within the fifth surrounding sidewall interior **565** with ground coffee **60**

placed within the coffee filter element **55** and hot water **65** poured over the ground coffee **60** to create a single cup of coffee.

(40) Optionally, in referring to FIGS. **1** to **3**, for the coffee filter holder **50**, wherein the first slot **460** and the second slot **475** that are engaged to one another on separate planar elements **440** are sized and configured to be removably engageable to one another to operationally facilitate each planar element **440** being separated to allow compact storage of at least three planar elements **440** being flat stacked upon one another with the fifth outer surfaces **500** and the fifth inner surfaces **505** being adjacent to one another. Further optionally, in referring to FIGS. **1** to **3**, for the coffee filter holder **50**, can further comprise a fourth planar element **440** to form the fifth surrounding sidewall **490** as a four-sided fifth surrounding sidewall **490**.

## CONCLUSION

(41) Accordingly, the present invention of a coffee filter holder has been described with some degree of particularity directed to the embodiments of the present invention. It should be appreciated, though; that the present invention is defined by the following claims construed in light of the prior art so modifications of the changes may be made to the exemplary embodiments of the present invention without departing from the inventive concepts contained therein.

## Claims

1. A coffee filter holder for supporting a coffee filter for use with a single serving coffee cup that has a base, a coffee cup surrounding sidewall extending from the base, and the coffee cup surrounding sidewall terminating in a coffee cup rim all defining a coffee cup interior, said coffee filter holder comprising: a third surrounding sidewall including a third outer surface and an opposing third inner surface, further said third surrounding sidewall having a third proximal end portion and an opposing third distal end portion with a third longitudinal axis spanning therebetween, wherein said third proximal end portion has a third proximal peripheral margin that defines a third proximal termination of said third surrounding sidewall, wherein said third proximal peripheral margin has a third proximal peripheral distance, further said third distal end portion has a third distal peripheral margin that defines a third distal termination of said third surrounding sidewall, wherein said third distal peripheral margin has a third distal peripheral distance, further said third distal peripheral distance is greater than said third proximal peripheral distance thus forming a cone shape for said third surrounding sidewall, wherein said third inner surface, said third proximal peripheral margin, and said third distal peripheral margin all define a third surrounding sidewall interior; and a planar member with a planar plane, said planar member also having an outer perimeter and a planar aperture disposed therethrough said planar member, wherein said third longitudinal axis and said planar plane are positioned perpendicular to one another, such that said third proximal end portion is partially received in said planar aperture, wherein operationally a portion of said planar member rests against the coffee cup rim thus suspending said third surrounding sidewall over the coffee cup interior with said third proximal peripheral margin adjacent to the coffee cup interior, wherein the coffee filter element is placed within said third surrounding sidewall interior with ground coffee placed within the coffee filter element and hot water poured over the ground coffee to create a single cup of coffee.

2. The coffee filter holder according to claim 1 wherein said third proximal end portion further comprises an interface aperture, wherein said interface aperture partially receives a portion of said planar aperture to operationally removably engage said third surrounding sidewall to said planar member.

3. The coffee filter holder according to claim 1 wherein said third surrounding sidewall further comprises flexible corners that operationally allow a fold flat state of said third surrounding sidewall that facilitates said planar member to slip within said third surrounding interior being adjacent to said third inner surface.

4. A coffee filter holder for supporting a coffee filter for use with a single serving coffee cup that has a base, a coffee cup surrounding sidewall extending from the base, and the coffee cup surrounding sidewall terminating in a coffee cup rim all defining a coffee cup interior, said coffee filter holder comprising: a flexible fourth surrounding sidewall including a fourth outer surface and an opposing fourth inner surface, further said fourth surrounding sidewall having a fourth proximal end portion and an opposing fourth distal end portion with a fourth longitudinal axis spanning therebetween, wherein said fourth proximal end portion has a fourth proximal peripheral margin that defines a fourth proximal termination of said fourth surrounding sidewall, wherein said fourth proximal peripheral margin has a fourth proximal peripheral distance, further said fourth distal end portion has a fourth distal peripheral margin that defines a fourth distal termination of said fourth surrounding sidewall, wherein said fourth distal peripheral margin has a fourth distal peripheral distance, further said fourth distal peripheral distance is greater than said fourth proximal peripheral distance thus forming a cone shape for said fourth surrounding sidewall, wherein said fourth inner surface, said fourth proximal peripheral margin, and said fourth distal peripheral margin all define a fourth surrounding sidewall interior, wherein said fourth surrounding sidewall forms a hexagonal pyramid in shape that has six fold lines in said fourth surrounding sidewall with each said fold line running substantially parallel to said fourth longitudinal axis, further at least one of said fold lines has a projection of excess fourth surrounding sidewall outside of said hexagonal pyramid shape to facilitate said fourth surrounding sidewall to fold flat for transportation and storage, wherein operationally a portion of said fourth proximal end portion rests against the coffee cup rim thus suspending said fourth surrounding sidewall over the coffee cup interior with said fourth proximal peripheral margin adjacent to the coffee cup interior, wherein the coffee filter element is placed within said fourth surrounding sidewall interior with ground coffee placed within the coffee filter element and hot water poured over the ground coffee to create a single cup of coffee.

5. The coffee filter holder according to claim 4 wherein said projection of excess further comprises four projection of excess sections having one on each corner of said flexible fourth surrounding sidewall to operationally enable a symmetric fold flat state and hexagonal pyramid shape of said fourth surrounding sidewall.

6. A coffee filter holder for supporting a coffee filter for use with a single serving coffee cup that has a base, a coffee cup surrounding sidewall extending from the base, and the coffee cup surrounding sidewall terminating in a coffee cup rim all defining a coffee cup interior, said coffee filter holder comprising: at least three planar elements that each include a lengthwise axis, with each planar element further including an outer perimeter that forms a polygon shape, wherein said outer perimeter includes a partial first slot therethrough said planar element wherein a first length of said partial first slot is substantially parallel to said lengthwise axis, further said outer perimeter includes an oppositely disposed partial second slot with a second length of said partial second slot positioned at an acute angle to said lengthwise axis, wherein said first slot and said second slot are engaged to one another on separate planar elements such that a fifth surrounding sidewall is formed by at least three of said planar elements, said fifth surrounding sidewall including a fifth outer surface and an opposing fifth inner surface, further said fifth surrounding sidewall having a fifth proximal end portion and an opposing fifth distal end portion with a fifth longitudinal axis spanning therebetween, wherein said fifth proximal end portion has a fifth proximal peripheral margin that defines a fifth proximal termination of said fifth surrounding sidewall, wherein said fifth proximal peripheral margin has a fifth proximal peripheral distance, further said fifth distal end portion has a fifth distal peripheral margin that defines a fifth distal termination of said fifth surrounding sidewall, wherein said fifth distal peripheral margin has a fifth distal peripheral distance, further said fifth distal peripheral distance is greater than said fifth proximal peripheral distance thus forming a cone shape for said fifth surrounding sidewall, wherein said fifth inner surface, said fifth proximal peripheral margin, and said fifth distal peripheral margin all define a fifth surrounding sidewall interior, wherein operationally a portion of said fifth proximal end

portion rests against the coffee cup rim thus suspending said fifth surrounding sidewall over the coffee cup interior with said fifth proximal peripheral margin adjacent to the coffee cup interior, wherein the coffee filter element is placed within said fifth surrounding sidewall interior with ground coffee placed within the coffee filter element and hot water poured over the ground coffee to create a single cup of coffee.

7. The coffee filter holder according to claim 6 wherein said first slot and said second slot that are engaged to one another on separate planar elements are sized and configured to be removably engageable to one another to operationally facilitate each said planar element being separated to allow compact storage of said least three planar elements being flat stacked upon one another with said fifth outer surfaces and said fifth inner surfaces being adjacent to one another.

8. The coffee filter holder according to claim 6 further comprising a fourth planar element to form said fifth surrounding sidewall as a four-sided fifth surrounding sidewall.

---